



6-14-2022 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=06jEtTGBrlc
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Muncie Community Schools Board of Trustees Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: June [exact date not explicitly stated in transcript, context indicates June 2022]

Location: Muncie, Indiana

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer (Board President Mr. Williams) called the meeting to order at [00:02:01](#). Opening statements included a moment of silence dedicated to individuals in Texas and the local community lacking adequate air conditioning during extreme heat waves, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Dr. O'Neill, Dr. Bales, Mr. Barnes Griffin, Mr. Irvin, Mr. Williams (President).
 - **Absent:** Mr. Heater (out of the country).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Williams.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Moment of silence for community heat/AC challenges and the Pledge of Allegiance.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Not explicitly detailed or voted upon in the available transcript excerpt.
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:03:04 Southside Middle School Robotics Team Recognition

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brian Jerome (Technology and Engineering Teacher at Southside Middle School).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Brian Jerome presented an update on the Southside robotics team's progression following their virtual appearance last year. Despite transitioning all prior students to high school, two new teams successfully competed in-person at the VEX IQ World Championship in Dallas, Texas, competing against teams from over 80 countries. Students developed essential STEM, engineering documentation, and global communication skills (coordinating with teams from London, Slovenia, and Colombia).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Presentation received with praise and commendation from board members; no formal board action required.

00:34:36 Application for Muncie Virtual Academy School Number

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Dr. Reynolds requested board approval to apply to the Indiana Department of Education (IDOE) for a new standalone school number for the Muncie Virtual Academy under Indiana Code 20-19-9-4, having met the threshold of at least 100 students. The accompanying handbook outlines onboarding requirements, attendance guidelines, and grading policies designed to streamline communication and establish structured checks and balances.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

00:37:39 Financial Report (May Results)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome (Chief Financial Officer).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Jerome presented the May financial report. State basic grant revenue is on track (approx. \$41.8 million expected by year-end). Year-to-date payroll increased by roughly \$1 million due to April pandemic stipends. The cash balance at the end of May stood at \$35 million, with an anticipated year-end balance exceeding \$34

million and an education fund surplus. Operations fund spending is running slightly high, prompting the need for an additional appropriation. Outside auditors (Crowe) are expected the second week of August.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

00:43:05 Waiver for Protected Taxes

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome (CFO).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Jerome requested approval to implement the waiver for protected taxes calculated by the Department of Local Government Finance (DLGF). Due to local tax caps, this waiver permits debt service to operation fund transfers, offering vital budgetary flexibility without increasing taxes or local levies.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

00:45:06 Fiscal Year-End Transfers

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome (CFO).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Request for administrative authorization to execute fiscal year-end transfers through the end of June to clear any negative balances and restore positive fund positions prior to closing.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

00:47:11 Public Hearing & Resolution: Additional Appropriation (Rainy Day Fund)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Williams (Board President) & Mr. Jerome (CFO).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board formally opened a statutory public hearing 00:47:11 to consider an additional appropriation of \$1.6 million from the Rainy Day Fund (Fund #610) to support unexpected capital repairs and offset state loan repayments (thereby relieving pressure on the education fund). With Rainy Day fund balances sitting at over \$12.1 million, this action does not raise tax rates or local levies; it simply grants spending authority. No public members spoke during the hearing, and the hearing was closed 00:49:03.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Resolution establishing the additional appropriation approved by Voice Vote.
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- No general public comment speakers participated during the open public comment period. (Note: Recognitions of new administrative staff<U+2014>Kayla Arguello, Randy McCracken, Kelsey Pavlik, Aicha Alan<U+2014>and farewell remarks from departing administrator Dylan Phelps occurred during administrative segments).
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff & Board Announcements:**
 - **COVID-19 Protocols:** Reopening COVID-19 protocols have been updated to satisfy federal DIA website requirements.
 - **Summer Programs & Nutrition:** Summer programs (career camp, adult English learner program, newcomers program, camp adventure) are running strong. Free summer meals are being provided for students 18 and younger across multiple school sites.
 - **Safety & Security:** Dr. K reported ongoing collaboration with Robert Scafe ("Legacy for Life") regarding SRO training, active shooter drills, cultural competency, and de-escalation training beginning the week of July 18th.
 - **Cradle to Career & Innovation Summit:** Muncie's application to the Strive Together network will be submitted this summer. The upcoming Innovation Summit is scheduled for September 16th, featuring keynote speaker Jeffrey Canada (Harlem Children's Zone).
 - **Upcoming Board Sessions:** A closed board education session is scheduled for June 28th at 4:00 PM at the offices of Defer Vane to review assessments, accountability, literacy, and security.
 - **Juneteenth Celebration:** Noted community Juneteenth celebration scheduled for June 19th from 3:00 PM to 9:00 PM at McCulloch Park.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was concluded with closing remarks and a voice vote [00:58:16](#). Exact adjournment time was not explicitly stated.
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